1.1 Introduction

Good nutrition along with food selection is the corner stone of personal health and for maintaining good health during and after diseases. The term "diet therapy" refers to the usage of food and nutrition in controlling symptoms and managing the progress of disease.

A therapeutic diet is a modified meal plan. The modification include increasing or decreasing intake of nutrients and change in texture.

1.1.1 Objectives of Diet Therapy

1. To maintain good nutritional status.
2. To correct nutrient deficiencies which may have occurred due to the disease.
3. To afford rest to the whole body or to the specific organ affected by the disease.
4. To adjust the food intake to the body's ability to metabolize the nutrients during the disease.
5. To bring about changes in body weight whenever necessary.

1.1.2 Principles of Therapeutic diet

A well planned diet provides all the specific nutrients to the body that are needed to achieve nutritional homeostasis in a normal healthy individual. However, in disease conditions, body tissues either do not receive proper nutrients in sufficient amount or cannot utilize the available nutrients owing to faulty digestion, absorption or transportation. Therefore, normal diet is modified to meet the requirements of the sick individual.

The normal diet may be modified to:

1. Provide change in consistency, as in fluid and soft diets.
2. Increase or decrease the energy values.
3. Include greater or lesser amounts of one or more nutrients.
4. Increase or decrease bulk- high and low fibre diets.
5. Include or exclude specific foods as in allergic conditions
6. To modify the intervals of feeding.

Factors to be considered in planning therapeutic diets

1. The underlying diseased condition which requires a change in the diet.
2. The possible duration of the disease.
3. The diet which must be altered to overcome these conditions.
4. The patients' tolerance for food by mouth.

In addition to economic status, the food preferences, occupation and time of meals should be considered.

The four attributes of a therapeutic diet are: Adequacy, Accuracy, Economy and Palatability.

1.1.3 Routine Hospital Diets

The routine hospital diets include Liquid diet, soft diet, mechanically altered, fibre restricted diet and regular diet.

i Liquid Diet

Liquid diet consists of food that will pour or liquid at normal room temperature. In this diet, nutritive value is

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